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Course: Indigenous People **Schedule:** Friday 4:00 – 5:30 PM

Personal Reflection: INDIGENOUS WORLDVIEWS AND APPROACHES

Through this lesson, I was able to get a deeper sense of what peace, life, and unity with nature means. Prior to this study, I used to see peace as the state of being free from any kind of conflicts. With the indigenous view, however, it becomes something more than just that. The concept of peace among indigenous societies involves harmony between God, nature, and other people.

Another key concept that I learned is that indigenous people like the Subanen are naturally peaceful. They do not find it easy to hate and make war with others and have their own indigenous methods of solving any conflicts arising within their society. In essence, peace for these people does not depend on coercion but is a practice that comes naturally. On the contrary, peace in modern society is associated with conflicts and violence.

Another significant theme in this context is the importance of their connection to land and nature. As the material describes, indigenous peoples perceive that for them, "land is life." In other words, their identity, survival, and culture cannot be detached from the land of their ancestors. It makes one understand that nowadays most people do not perceive the land the same way. In most cases, land is perceived as a possession or resource. Such an attitude to land leads to ecological issues including pollution and deforestation. Indigenous culture helps us learn that nature needs to be treated respectfully because it is a part of our being.

Furthermore, one can note that the Subanen tribe perceives the existence of one Supreme Being named Magbabaya. In addition, they regularly perform different rituals and offer sacrifices to God. One should admit that it is another proof of the fact that spirituality and religion are deeply integrated into everyday life and not only practiced occasionally. In addition, this tribe believes in the presence of spirits in nature such as water, forests, and even mountains. It helps them respect nature more than others do.

Another vital lesson learned was the concept of unity and community. Unity is an essential aspect of the Subanen culture. For example, the Buklog festival reflects unity within family members and within the community as well. Instead of emphasizing individual accomplishments, the Subanens emphasize the prosperity of all members. This is vastly different from the current societies where individuals' interests dominate the community's general well-being. It became clear to me that unity creates a more harmonious environment where everybody feels secure.

Finally, I found it interesting how the Subanens perceive leadership. For instance, the 'Timuay' acts as an intermediary who ensures peace within the community by settling disputes. This clearly indicates that leadership involves guiding individuals.

However, another point highlighted in the material is that indigenous peoples experience discrimination and stereotyping. Some individuals view them as inferior or believe that they have little knowledge compared to others. It is unfair because the indigenous population possesses profound knowledge acquired through numerous generations. I would say that indigenous peoples deserve more appreciation and recognition from society.

To conclude, this topic allowed me to comprehend that indigenous worldviews contain vital lessons applicable in everyday life. Their approaches to achieving peace, reverence of nature, spirituality, and community are qualities often lacking in modern societies. Rather than rejecting these viewpoints, we need to embrace them and attempt to integrate them into contemporary practice.

Finally, from this discussion, one learns that indigenous worldviews emphasize harmony with nature, other individuals, and God. The Subanen culture teaches us to find harmony in all spheres of life.